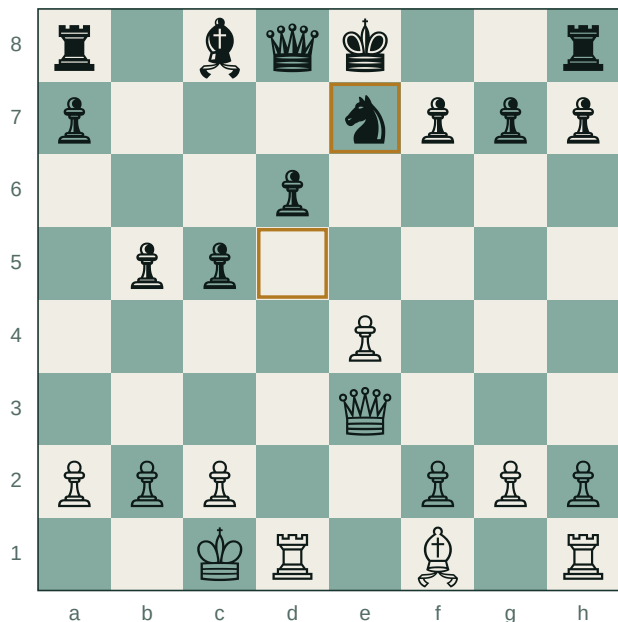


Interference tactics: White, move 12

Interference tactics

White to move



Previous move: 11...Nxe7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

12. Bxb5+ Bd7 13. Rxd6 Bxb5 14. Rxd8+

12.Bxb5+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on b5. Recorded reply: **12...Bd7**.

13.Rxd6 The rook captures the pawn on d6. Recorded reply: **13...Bxb5**.

14.Rxd8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From d8 it attacks king on e8 and rook on a8.

At the end, nominal material is White 26 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -3 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.